

A Personalized Audit Showing Exactly Which Make/Airtable/Shopify Workflows Will Save You 10+ Hrs/Week

The Trap Most Online SMBs Fall Into

You're running a Shopify store, selling on Takealot, maybe eBay. Orders come in. You're manually: - Copying orders from Takealot → Shopify → Xero - Updating inventory across 3 platforms - Answering the same "Where's my order?" WhatsApp/email/Instagram DMs - Building reports in Google Sheets at 11 PM on Sundays

You don't have an automation problem. You have a prioritization problem.

There are 50+ things you *could* automate. Only 3 will give you 80% of the time back.

The 3-Automation Framework We Use With Every Client

Step 1: Map Your "Time Tax" (15 min)

List every repetitive task. Score each: - **Frequency:** How many times/day/week? - **Duration:** Minutes per occurrence? - **Error Cost:** What happens when it breaks? (Lost sale, angry customer, compliance issue) - **Automatability:** Can a tool do this reliably? (1-5 scale)

Formula: $\text{Priority Score} = \text{Frequency} \times \text{Duration} \times \text{Error Cost} \times \text{Automatability}$

Step 2: The Universal Top 3 for Online SMBs

After auditing 40+ SA e-commerce businesses, these 3 **always** rank highest:

#1: Unified Order → Inventory → Accounting Sync

Time Saved: 5-8 hrs/week

Tools: Make + Shopify + Takealot API + Xero/QuickBooks + Airtable (buffer)

The Flow:

```
New Order (Shopify/Takealot/eBay) → Make router →
├─ Create/Update order in Airtable (single source of truth)
├─ Decrement inventory in Airtable → Push to ALL channels
├─ Create invoice in Xero → Email customer
└─ Tag customer in Klaviyo/HubSpot for post-purchase flow
```

Why it wins: Eliminates overselling. Kills double-entry. Accounting stays current automatically.

Setup Complexity: Medium (Takealot API needs approval)

Maintenance: Near-zero once running

#2: Customer Comms Unification (WhatsApp + Email + Instagram → One Inbox)

Time Saved: 3-5 hrs/week

Tools: Make + Gmail + WhatsApp Business API (Twilio) + Instagram Graph API + Airtable/Notion

The Flow:

```
Incoming message (any channel) → Make webhook →  
├─ Log to Airtable "Comms" table (thread ID, channel, customer, timestamp)  
├─ Check: Existing customer? → Pull order history, attach to record  
├─ Auto-reply: "Got it! [Name] responds within 2 hrs" (customized per channel)  
└─ Notify team: Slack/Email/Telegram with context + quick-reply buttons
```

Why it wins: No more missed DMs. Context at fingertips. Response time drops from hours → minutes.

Setup Complexity: Low-Medium

Maintenance: Add new channels in 10 min

#3: Automated Reporting You Actually Read

Time Saved: 2-3 hrs/week (but better decisions = more revenue)

Tools: Make + Airtable → Google Slides / Notion / Email / WhatsApp

The Flow:

```
Daily 7 AM: Make pulls yesterday's data from Airtable (orders, revenue, conversion, ad spend,  
inventory alerts) →  
├─ Builds 1-page dashboard in Google Slides/Notion  
├─ Emails PDF to you + key team  
├─ WhatsApp voice note summary (via ElevenLabs TTS): "Yesterday: R47K revenue, 23 orders,  
3.2% conv. Stock alert: SKU-402 at 12 units."  
└─ Flags anomalies: "Conv dropped 40% vs 7-day avg – check Meta ads"
```

Why it wins: You *actually* read it. Takes 60 seconds. Anomalies caught early.

Setup Complexity: Low

Maintenance: Zero

Your Personalized Audit: What You'll Get

Fill the form → We analyze your stack + pain points → Within 24 hrs you receive:

Deliverable	Format	What's Inside
Time Tax Audit	Notion page	Every repetitive task scored & ranked

Deliverable	Format	What's Inside
Top 3 Automations	PDF + Loom video	Exact Make scenarios, effort estimates, ROI calc
"Start This Week" Pick	1-pager	The single highest-leverage build with step-by-step
Tool Gap Analysis	Spreadsheet	What you have, what you need, what to kill
30-min Strategy Call	Calendly link	Walk through the plan, Q&A, decide next steps

Real Example: "Sarah's Curated Homewares" (Cape Town)

Before: 14 hrs/week manual ops across Shopify, Takealot, Instagram, Xero

Top 3 Identified: 1. Order→Inventory→Xero sync (saved 6.5 hrs) 2. Instagram DM → Airtable → Slack (saved 3 hrs) 3. Weekly dashboard to WhatsApp (saved 1.5 hrs + better decisions)

Result: 11 hrs/week reclaimed. First automation live in 3 days.

Revenue impact: +R340K in 90 days (faster fulfillment → better reviews → repeat rate ↑ 18%)

The Stack We Recommend (Free to Start)

Layer	Tool	Why
Automation	Make	Visual, powerful, 1,000 free ops
Database	Airtable	1,000 records free, great UI
WhatsApp	Twilio or WhatsApp Business App	API vs. manual tradeoff
Scheduling	Calendly	Free tier solid
Forms	Tally.so	Unlimited, beautiful, free
Reporting	Google Slides/Notion	Free, shareable
TTS (voice notes)	ElevenLabs	10k chars/mo free

At scale: ~R1,500-3,000/mo (Make Pro + Twilio + ElevenLabs)

Ready for Your Roadmap?

Book a free 30-minute AI Strategy Call and we'll: 1. Run your Time Tax Audit live (15 min) 2. Show the exact Make scenarios for your stack (10 min) 3. Give you the deployment files — or build turnkey (5 min)

No pitch. No pressure. Just your 3-automation roadmap.

→ **Book Your Free Call Here**

Agency — Custom Automation for South African Businesses
hello@agency.co.za | agency.co.za | +27 83 791 5429